

《Social Media: Connecting Us or Tearing Us Apart?》

Part 0 — Opening (约 1 分钟)

开场

Alex (Host 主持人) :

Good afternoon, everyone. Welcome to our roundtable discussion. Today we're talking about something that has quietly become part of almost every moment of our lives: social media. We use it to connect with friends, to express ourselves, to get news, to relax, and sometimes to escape from reality.

But there's a question we can't avoid: **Is social media really bringing us closer together, or is it slowly pushing us apart—emotionally, socially, and even mentally?**

In the next minutes, we'll explore three main aspects:

1. how social media affects our **mental health and emotions**,
2. how it changes our **communication and relationships**,
3. and what **solutions and responsibilities** we might have as users and as a society.

I hope everyone can speak openly, challenge ideas respectfully, and build on each other's thoughts. Let's dive in.

大家下午好，欢迎来到今天的圆桌讨论。今天我们要谈的是一个几乎已经渗透进我们生活每一分钟的话题：社交媒体。我们用它联系朋友、表达自我、获取信息、放松自己，有时候甚至用它来逃避现实。

但有一个问题我们始终绕不开：**社交媒体真的让我们彼此更亲近了吗？还是在悄悄地拉开我们在情感上、社交上、甚至心理上的距离？**

接下来，我们会从三个方面来讨论：

1. 社交媒体对**心理健康和情绪**的影响；
2. 它如何改变我们的**沟通方式和人际关系**；
3. 以及作为用户和社会一员，我们在**解决问题和承担责任**方面可以做些什么。

希望大家都能坦诚表达、礼貌质疑、互相补充观点。那我们就开始吧。

Part 1 — Self-Introductions (约 3 分钟)

成员自我介绍

David:

Hi everyone, I'm David. I'm especially interested in how social media affects our emotions—things like anxiety, loneliness, and self-worth.

大家好，我是大卫。我尤其关注社交媒体如何影响我们的情绪，比如焦虑、孤独和自我价值感。

Priya:

Hi, I'm Priya. I'm curious about how social media can connect people so quickly, but at the same time create conflicts and division.

大家好，我是普里亚。我很好奇，社交媒体一方面能快速连接人，另一方面又会制造矛盾和分裂。

Mark:

Hello, I'm Mark. I want to understand whether social media is improving our communication or quietly damaging it.

大家好，我是马克。我想弄明白，社交媒体到底是在改善我们的沟通，还是在悄悄破坏它。

Chen:

Hi, I'm Chen. I'm interested in the psychological design behind social media—how colors, notifications, and algorithms guide our behavior.

大家好，我是陈。我对社交媒体背后的心理设计很感兴趣，比如颜色、提醒和算法是如何引导我们行为的。

Maria:

Hi, I'm Maria. I care a lot about how social media changes the way young people talk to each other, and whether we are losing deeper conversations.

大家好，我是玛丽亚。我很在意社交媒体如何改变年轻人的交流方式，以及我们是否正在失去更有深度的对话。

Ryan:

Hello, I'm Ryan. I'm here because I want to talk about social media's role in spreading information—and misinformation.

大家好，我是瑞安。我想讨论的是社交媒体在传播信息以及错误信息方面扮演的角色。

Sofia:

Hi, I'm Sofia. I'm interested in how social media shapes public opinion and influences social movements and communities.

大家好，我是索菲亚。我关注社交媒体如何塑造公众舆论，以及它对社会运动和社群

的影响。

Alex (Host):

Great, thank you all. Now let's move into our first topic: mental health and emotional impact.

很好，谢谢大家。接下来我们进入第一个话题：心理健康与情绪影响。

Part 2 — Topic 1: Mental Health & Emotional Impact (约 4–5 分钟)

主题一：心理健康与情绪影响

Alex:

David, since you're especially interested in this area, could you start us off? How does social media affect mental health?

大卫，既然你对这一块特别感兴趣，就从你开始吧。你觉得社交媒体是怎样影响心理健康的？

Round 1 — Everyone speaks once (争论 + 追问 + 补充)

第一轮：每人一次发言（有质疑、有补充）

David:

Sure. Many studies show that reducing social media use can lower levels of loneliness and depression. One key reason is constant comparison. When people scroll, they see others' "perfect" lives—perfect trips, perfect faces, perfect achievements. Even if they know it's filtered, they still feel "not good enough," and that slowly hurts their self-esteem.

可以。很多研究都表明，减少社交媒体使用可以降低孤独和抑郁的水平。一个核心原因就是**不断的比较**。当人们刷社交媒体时，经常看到别人的“完美生活”——完美的旅行、完美的脸、完美的成就。即使理智上知道这些是经过筛选的，情绪上还是会觉得“自己不够好”，时间一长，自尊就会受到伤害。

Priya (Challenge 追问):

David, I agree comparison is a big issue, but haven't people always compared themselves to others? Why do you think social media makes it so much worse?

大卫，我同意比较是个大问题，但人类本来就会互相比啊。你觉得为什么到了社交媒体这里，这个问题会变得更严重？

David:

Good question. I think the difference is scale and frequency. Offline, you compare

yourself to a small circle. Online, you compare yourself to hundreds of people, and they're all showing their best moments. Plus, we check our phones many times a day, so that comparison gets repeated over and over.

这是个好问题。我觉得区别在于**规模和频率**。线下你只会和身边一小圈人比较，线上你会和几百个人比较，而且他们都只展示最好的瞬间。另外，我们一天会无数次看手机，这种比较就被不断重复。

Mark (Add 补充):

I'd add that it's not just more comparison, it's **unfair comparison**. You compare your whole life—with good days and bad days—to someone else's highlight reel. That gap creates a lot of pressure.

我想补充的是，这不仅是比较次数变多的问题，而是**比较本身就不公平**。你拿自己有好有坏的整个人生，去对比别人精心挑选出来的“高光时刻”，这种落差本身就会带来巨大的压力。

Chen (Challenge 追问):

Mark, do you think this is mainly about personal mindset, or do you think platforms are actively pushing this kind of content because it keeps people engaged?

马克，那你觉得问题主要出在个体心态上，还是说平台其实在主动推这种内容，因为这种东西更容易留住用户？

Mark:

Honestly, it's both. People are naturally curious and competitive, and platforms use that. The more “perfect” posts you see, the longer you stay. It becomes a loop.

老实说，两者都有。人本身就有好奇心和比较心，而平台正好利用这一点。你看到的“完美内容”越多，就越容易一直刷下去，这就形成了一个循环。

Maria (Add 补充):

I see this clearly in younger people. Some of them say things like, “If my post doesn't get enough likes, I feel embarrassed or even upset.” Their mood rises and falls with numbers on a screen.

这一点在年轻人身上特别明显。有些人会说：“如果我的帖子点赞不多，我就觉得很丢脸，甚至心情很差。”他们的情绪完全被屏幕上的一个数字牵着走。

Ryan (New angle 新角度):

And it's not only about comparison. Misinformation also affects mental health. When people constantly see exaggerated or false news, they can feel anxious, angry, or hopeless—even if the thing they're afraid of isn't actually happening.

而且问题不只是比较。错误信息同样会影响心理健康。当人们不停看到夸张甚至虚假的消息时，就会感到焦虑、愤怒，甚至对未来感到绝望——哪怕他们害怕的事情根本没发生。

Sofia (Add 补充):

Exactly. And emotions spread fast online. Fear, anger, outrage—they all go viral more easily than calm or neutral content. So one emotional post doesn't just affect one person, it affects thousands.

没错。而且情绪在网上传播得非常快。恐惧、愤怒、愤慨，这些情绪的传播速度远比平静、中立的信息快得多。所以一条情绪爆炸的内容影响的不是一个人，而是成千上万个人。

Alex (小结 Mini-summary):

So from what I hear, social media doesn't just “create” emotions out of nowhere, but it **magnifies** comparison, insecurity, and emotional reactions through design and constant exposure.

从大家刚才的发言来看，社交媒体并不是凭空创造情绪，而是通过平台设计和高频接触，不断放大比较、不安全感和各种情绪反应。

接下来，我们来看看它是如何改变我们的沟通方式和人际关系的。

Part 3 — Topic 2: Communication & Relationships (约 4–5 分钟)

主题二：沟通与人际关系

Alex:

Let's move on to communication. Do you think social media has improved the way we interact, or has it made our relationships weaker?

我们来谈谈沟通。你们觉得社交媒体是在改善我们的互动方式，还是在削弱我们的关系？

Round 2 — Everyone speaks once (有反驳、有例子)

第二轮：每人一次发言

Mark:

I think communication is definitely faster, but often shallower. Instead of saying how we really feel, we send an emoji, a “lol,” or just a like. It keeps conversations going, but sometimes it replaces real understanding.

我觉得沟通的确更快了，但往往也更浅。很多时候我们不再认真说出自己的想法，而是发一个表情、一个“lol”，或者点个赞。这样对话是继续下去了，但有时候真正的理解却被替代了。

Priya (Challenge 追问):

But Mark, is “shallow” always bad? Emojis and memes are also a kind of language. Maybe they just show that communication is evolving, not disappearing.
但马克，“浅”一定是坏事吗？表情包和梗图也算是一种语言啊。也许这只是沟通方式在“进化”，而不是“消失”。

Mark:

I agree they're creative, but my worry is when they become a *shortcut* to avoid deeper conversations. If we only react but never explain, misunderstandings pile up.
我同意这些东西很有创意，但我担心的是，当它们变成我们**逃避深度沟通的捷径**时，就会有问题。如果我们只会“反应”，不会“解释”，误解就会越积越多。

Chen:

And social media encourages quick reactions. Typing a short reply is rewarded; taking time to think is not. Over time, that can weaken our ability to listen carefully and respond thoughtfully.
而且社交媒体鼓励的是“快速反应”。打几个字马上回，会被鼓励；认真思考、慢一点回复，反而不被鼓励。时间一长，我们认真倾听和深思熟虑回应的能力就会被削弱。

Maria (Counter-example 反例):

I do agree there's a problem, but I've also seen the opposite. Some people have really honest and meaningful conversations on social media about study pressure, family conflicts, or mental struggles. Those conversations are very genuine. They just don't go as viral as funny videos, so it feels like they're less common.

我确实认同存在问题，但我也看到一些相反的例子。比如有些人会在社交媒体上认真聊学习压力、家庭矛盾、心理困扰。那些对话非常真诚。只是这些内容不像搞笑视频那样“吸睛”，所以看上去好像没那么普遍。

Ryan:

Still, misunderstandings are definitely more frequent online. Without tone and facial expression, a neutral sentence can sound sarcastic or cold. I've seen conflicts start from a single misread message.

不过，线上误解确实更频繁。没有语气和表情，一句本来中性的文字很容易被读成讽刺或者冷漠。我见过不少矛盾就是从一条被读错味的消息开始的。

Sofia:

And relationships themselves are changing. Some people feel very close to someone they only chat with online, but when they meet in real life, they suddenly feel awkward or distant. The comfort zone has moved from offline to online.

而且人际关系的形态也在改变。有些人在线上跟一个人聊得特别投机，但一旦线下见面，就突然觉得很尴尬、很陌生。人们的“舒适区”正在从线下转移到线上。

David:

I think the core issue is that social media makes communication easier to start but harder to deepen. It's very easy to send a message, but much harder to move from small talk to real talk.

我觉得核心问题是：社交媒体让“开口说话”变容易了，却让“聊深一点”变难了。发一条消息很简单，但从寒暄聊到真正重要的话题却变得更困难。

Alex (小结 Mini-summary):

So again, we see both sides: social media creates new chances to communicate, but also introduces new barriers to understanding.

看来这里同样是两面性：社交媒体一方面创造了新的沟通机会，另一方面也带来了新的理解障碍。

下面我们进入最后一个主题——既然问题存在，那我们能做些什么？

Part 4 — Topic 3: Solutions & Responsibilities (约 4-5 分钟)

主题三：解决方案与责任

Alex:

Given all these challenges, what can we actually do? Both as individual users and as a larger society, how can we make social media healthier?

既然问题这么多，那我们实际上能做些什么呢？无论是作为个体用户，还是作为社会的一员，我们如何让社交媒体变得更健康？

Round 3 — Everyone speaks once (方案讨论)

第三轮：每人一次发言（讨论解决方案）

Priya:

For individuals, I think the first step is awareness and boundaries. We need to notice how we feel when we use social media—if we always feel anxious or drained, that's a warning sign. Setting small limits, like no phone before bed or during meals, can already make a difference.

对个人来说，我觉得第一步是“有意识”和“设界限”。我们要学会觉察自己在刷社交媒体时的感受——如果每次刷完都觉得焦虑、空虚，那就是一个警告。哪怕只是设定一些小规则，比如睡前半小时不刷手机、吃饭时不看手机，其实都能带来改变。

Chen:

But we can't put everything on users. Platforms also need to change their design. If they

keep using addictive features like infinite scroll and constant notifications, most people will struggle to control their usage, no matter how “aware” they are.

不过，责任不能都压在用户身上。平台也必须改变设计。如果它们继续使用无限下滑、频繁提醒这样的上瘾功能，即使用户再有“意识”，大多数人还是很难真正控制自己的使用时间。

Mark:

That's why I think digital literacy education is important. We should be teaching not only how to use apps, but how to critically think, manage time, and protect our emotions online—starting from school, but also for adults.

这也是我认为“数字素养教育”很重要的原因。我们不光要教大家怎么用软件，更要教大家如何批判性思考、如何管理时间、如何在网上保护自己的情绪——这不只应该教给学生，成年人同样需要。

Maria:

At the same time, I think we need to relearn how to interact offline. Social skills require practice—things like listening, making eye contact, saying “no” face to face, and showing care in real life. If we only practice these skills online and never use them offline, they can slowly fade away.

与此同时，我们也要重新“练习”线下相处。社交技能是需要练习的，比如倾听、眼神交流、面对面地说“不”、在现实生活中表达关心。如果这些事情只在线上做，而线下不做，这些能力就会慢慢退化。

Ryan:

For society as a whole, I think one key is dealing with misinformation. Platforms should label doubtful content more clearly and reduce the spread of harmful rumors. And we, as users, must learn to fact-check before we share.

对整个社会来说，我觉得一个关键点是处理“错误信息”。平台应该更清晰地标注存疑内容、减少有害谣言的传播。而作为用户，我们也要学会在转发之前，先简单核实一下信息。

Sofia:

I also hope platforms can redesign their algorithms to promote healthier content. Right now, extreme or emotional posts often get pushed the most. Imagine if content that encouraged empathy, reflection, or constructive discussion had the same visibility.

我也希望平台能重新设计算法，让更健康的内容被看见。现在往往是极端、情绪化的内容更容易被推送。如果那些鼓励同理心、反思、理性讨论的内容，也能获得类似的曝光，整个网络环境可能会不一样。

David:

In the end, I think responsibility is shared. Users need awareness and self-regulation, platforms need ethical design, schools need to teach digital skills, and society needs to keep having honest conversations like this one.

最后，我觉得责任是“共同的”。用户需要觉察和自我管理，平台需要更有伦理的设计，学校需要教授数字技能，而整个社会也需要像今天这样，持续地、诚实地讨论这些问题。

Alex (小结):

So solutions don't come from one side alone. They require cooperation between individuals, platforms, and institutions.

可见，解决方案不可能只来自某一方，而需要个人、平台和社会机构之间的配合与协作。

Part 5 — Final Reflections (约 3 分钟)

总结感悟 (每人约 20 秒)

Alex:

To wrap up, I'd like each of you to share one short takeaway from today's discussion. 在结束之前，我想请每个人用一句话，说一说今天对你来说最重要的收获。

David:

Today reminded me that social media isn't simply good or bad—it's powerful. And we need to treat powerful things carefully.

今天让我再次意识到，社交媒体不是好或坏的问题，而是它“太有力量了”，而强大的东西必须被小心对待。

Priya:

For me, the key word is balance. Social media connects us, but without boundaries, it can also hurt us.

对我来说，关键词是“平衡”。社交媒体让我们更靠近，但如果没有界限，它同样会伤害我们。

Mark:

I realized that communication is changing, and it's our job to make sure that change doesn't cost us real understanding.

我意识到沟通方式在改变，而我们的任务，是在这种变化中不要失去真正的“理解”。

Chen:

I hope more people can see that it's not just about self-control—platform design also

matters, and it should be questioned.

我希望更多人意识到，这不只是自律问题，平台设计同样需要被质疑和改进。

Maria:

I'm reminded that speed itself isn't the enemy; the real problem is the lack of depth. We need to actively create moments to slow down in this fast-paced digital life.

我意识到，真正的敌人不是“快”，而是“没有深度”。我们需要在快节奏的数字生活中主动为自己创造“慢下来”的时刻。

Ryan:

My takeaway is that critical thinking online is not optional anymore—it's necessary for mental health and for a healthy society.

我的收获是：在网络世界里保持批判性思维，不再是一个可选项，而是维护心理健康和社会健康的必需品。

Sofia:

I feel that social media is shaping society every day, and we all have a role in deciding whether that influence is positive or negative.

我意识到社交媒体每天都在塑造社会，而它最终变成正面力量还是负面力量，我们每个人都在其中扮演着角色。

Alex (Host):

Thank you all for your thoughtful ideas. This has been a rich and meaningful conversation.

谢谢大家的真诚分享。这是一场既丰富又有意义的讨论。